

Portfolio - Layout & Grid

Learning Objectives

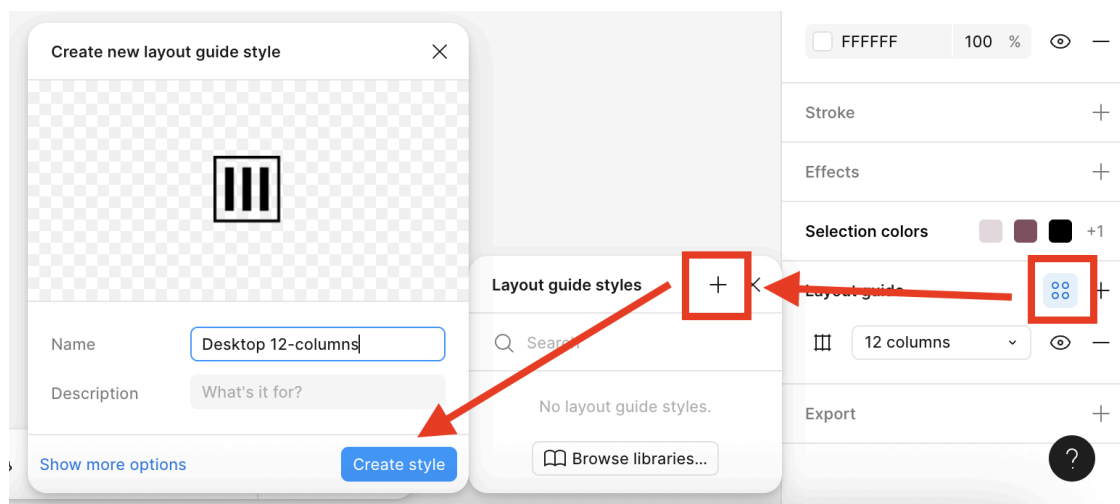
By the end of this session, you will be able to:

1. Apply a *Layout Grid* to enforce visual structure and consistency.
2. Create and apply *Spacing Variables* (design tokens) for standardized padding and margins.
3. Utilize *Auto Layout* to build dynamic, responsive components.
4. Define *Component Variables* (Boolean and Text) for component flexibility.
5. Reuse components and understand how they interact with the grid.

The Layout Grid: Establishing Structure (15 min)

Goal: Apply a 12-column grid to your project detail page

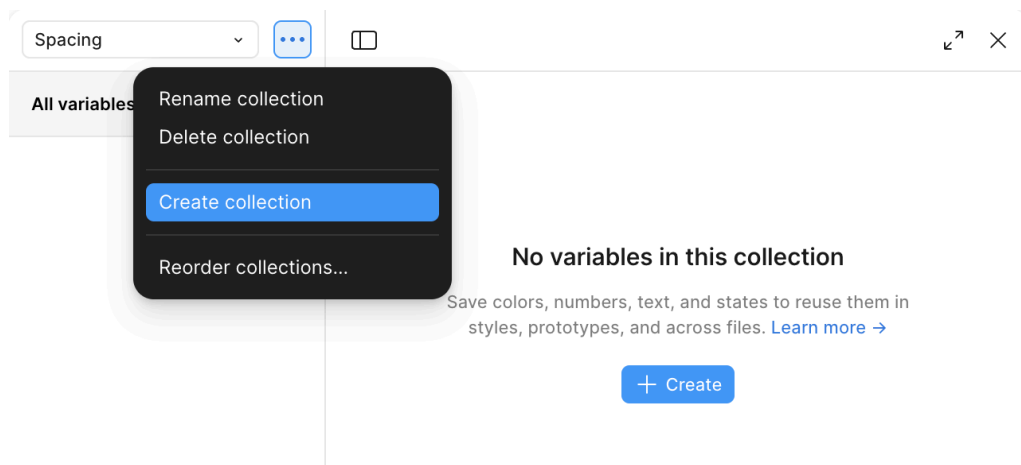
- Select your project detail page artboard
- In the right sidebar, click the + icon next to Layout Grid.
- Click the nine-dot icon and change the type from Grid to Columns.
- Set the following parameters: Count: 12, Type: Stretch, Margin: 80, Gutter: 24.
- Quickly adjust the main elements on your existing Detail Page (e.g., header, main content block) to snap them to the new 12-column lines.
- Save the created Layout as Style. Now it's possible to reuse it on other pages



Spacing Variables: Consistency via Tokens (15 min)

Instead of manually setting padding/margins, we use a standardized scale based on multiples (like 8px) to create "tokens" that enforce consistency.

- De-select everything
- Click the Open Variables icon in the right sidebar.
- Create a new collection called *Spacing*.



- Create a new collection called *Spacing*. Add the variables
 - space-xs: 8
 - space-sm: 16
 - space-md: 24
 - space-lg: 32
 - space-xl: 48

Component Build-Up: Auto Layout Mastery (35 min)

Auto Layout is the core engine of flexible design. We will build a reusable Action Box component.

- Create a *Title* text layer, a *Body Text* layer, and a placeholder *Button* (a rectangle with text).
- Group Text: Select Title and Body Text. Press *Shift + A* (Auto Layout).
- Apply Variable: In the Auto Layout panel, set the vertical space (gap between items) to the space-sm (16) variable.
- Select the new Group and the already existing button. Press *Shift + A* again.
- Set the vertical space (gap between items) to the space-md (24) variable.
- Padding: Select the outermost Auto Layout frame. In the right sidebar, set the Horizontal Padding and Vertical Padding to the space-lg (32) variable.
- Background: Give the outermost frame a fill color (e.g., a light gray).

- Fill Container: Set the outermost frame's horizontal resizing to Fill Container. Now, select the inner text frame and button, and ensure their horizontal resizing is also set to Fill Container. This is critical for responsiveness!
- Select the outermost frame and press Ctrl+Alt+K (or right-click > Create Component).
- In the Component properties section (right sidebar, near the top), add the following variables:
 - Boolean: Name it Show Button. Target the visibility of the Button layer.
 - Text: Name it Box Title. Target the content of the Title layer.

Reuse and Grid Integration (10 min)

- Drag two instances of your Action Box component onto your Detail Page. Place them side-by-side, within the grid.
- Resize: Drag the first box's width to span 4 columns. Drag the second box's width to span 8 columns.
- Test: Since we set the inner elements to Fill Container, they should adapt perfectly to the new widths.

Homework: Layout & Grid - The Home Page

Goal: Apply the grid, spacing, Auto Layout, and basic component techniques we learned today to a new page.

Task: Design the Home Page for your existing project.

1. Desktop Design (Focus on Grid)

- Create a new desktop frame.
- Apply the **12-column grid** setup from our session.
- Lay out the main sections (Hero, Features, Footer).
- Ensure all content aligns with the 12 columns.

2. Mobile Adaptation (Focus on Layout)

- Create a separate mobile frame (e.g., 375px wide).
- Adapt the grid to a **4-column layout** (adjusting margins and gutters).
- Redesign the content to stack vertically and work on the mobile grid.

3. Variable Usage (Focus on Spacing)

- **MANDATORY:** Use your **Spacing Variables** for all internal padding and external margins.
- Build one component **Project Box**

- Use at least three instances of your **Project Box** component and adjust the content in it (text)
4. Select File > Save a local copy > Upload the .fig file in e-learning